

Unit Student Learning Outcomes (SLOs)

- Differentiate between state and government.
- Describe the purpose of government.
- Describe the main features of the government of Pakistan (federal, democratic, parliamentary).
- Explain why Pakistan has a federal system of government.
- Identify the organizational structure of the federal government of Pakistan (legislative, executive and judicial branches).
- Describe the power and functions of each branch of government.
- Describe how the Prime Minister, members of the National Assembly and justices of the Supreme Court come to power (election v.s appointments).
- Explain why the powers of government are separated among the three branches.
- Give examples of how the system of checks and balances, limits the power of the federal government (e.g. senate not agreeing to legislation, courts declaring a law unconstitutional).
- Differentiate between those branches and institutions of government that are permanent and temporary.
- Identify the role of the civil and military bureaucracies.
- Distinguish between federal and provincial government.
- Make a chart to show the relationship between courts in the judicial system of Pakistan.
- Identify an unjust situation and say how they can be made more just?
- Discuss in groups the importance of ensuring justice to reach a member of the society.
- Describe the powers of the federal (e.g. minting money, declaring war), provincial (e.g. providing education and health) and local government in Pakistan (e.g. cleanliness).
- Describe government policies and actions aimed at serving its citizens.
- Identify key features of local government.
- Name some local government institutions.

- Identify services commonly provided by local government (e.g. police, fire department, schools, libraries, parks, health and cleanliness) and describe how they are funded (e.g. taxes, fees, fines).
- Give examples to show how local government affects the lives of its citizens.
- Recognize that people in authority are respected under some conditions (e.g. when they are just, fair and respect others).
- Elections ("Role of citizens").
- Describe the term election, electorate and representatives.
- State the importance of elections in a democracy.
- State the importance of active citizens participates in the electorate process (voting, observer in elections, and stand for elections).
- Identify the problem of woman citizens have in participating in the political process and suggest ways to address them.
- Go through the electoral process in school (elections for class monitor, elections for members and leaders of the school council).
- Examine the role of media in the election process.
- Describe the role of political parties in the electoral process in Pakistan.

Introduction to the Unit

The government of the country affects our everyday life. Governments decide the rules we have to live by and to a large extent the conditions we live in. Pakistan has a democratic system of government. In a democracy, citizens make decisions regarding who will be their leaders and what laws will be made by their elected representatives. They exercise their power through the process of voting during elections. After elections, the government is formed and it is accountable to the people for its actions. It is, therefore, important for young people to learn as much as possible about the government and how it works as it would help them make educated decisions at the time of elections.

CHAPTER 1: GOVERNMENT

SLOs

- Differentiate between state and government.
- Describe the purpose of government.
- Describe the main features of the government of Pakistan (federal, democratic, parliamentary).
- Explain why Pakistan has a federal system of government.

Introduction

In this chapter, we will study about the government, its functions and main features of the government of Pakistan.

What is Government?

Government is a group of people that exercises control over a country (a state). It has the authority to make the laws and public policies for the country as a whole, for example, Pakistan or for a particular part of a country such as a province, for example, Sindh.

State

A state is a group of people organized on definite territory for a common purpose. The main elements of state include territory, population, government and sovereignty.

Activity:

- List the differences between state and government.

Functions of Government

There are many functions of government. The main functions of government are listed below:

- To protect the life and property of its citizens. It must also have to maintain Armed forces for defending the territory and people against the foreign invasion.
- To protect the fundamental rights of people. The 1973 Constitution of Pakistan lists the fundamental rights of citizens. It is the duty of the government to protect the rights of its citizens guaranteed by the constitution.
- To provide public services for the welfare of the people. The

government is responsible to provide services such as education and health care to the people. It is also its responsibility to introduce social and economic welfare programmes for the needy.

- To provide public goods and services. One of the main functions of government is to provide various facilities to its citizens including roads, markets, bridges, drinking water, sanitation, and electricity etc.
- To promote the ideology of the country that is the major source of identity. Each country has its own traditions and culture that gives it its identity. The government must protect and uphold the identity of the country.
- To protect and safeguard National Interest (NI), the state engages into trade agreements with other sovereign states.

Main Features of the Government of Pakistan

Pakistan is a democratic state. It has a parliamentary form of government. Main features are discussed as under:

Federal System of Government

Pakistan has a federal system of government. This means that the powers of government are divided between the federal (national) government and the provincial governments. Each level of government, that is, federal and provincial, has complete power in some areas and shares powers in other areas. The federal government usually has complete power over matters affecting the country as whole such as finance, foreign affairs and defense. Provincial governments have complete powers over matters such as education and health care. Both the federal and provincial governments have the power to impose taxes.

According to the constitution, the following are the federating units of Pakistan:

- The Four Provinces: Sindh, Punjab, Khyber Pakhtunkhwa and Balochistan.
- The Federal capital territory: Islamabad.
- The Federally Administered Tribal Areas (FATA).
- Gilgit Baltistan.

Map of Pakistan: Provinces



Democratic Form of Government

Democracy means rule by the people. Since all the people cannot rule, they choose from among themselves representatives to rule on their behalf through democratic elections. All adult citizens have the right to participate (vote) in free, fair and regular elections.

Other important characteristics of a democratic government are that it grants rights and freedom to the citizens and ensures the rule of law. The law is supreme and all the citizens are equal in the eyes of law. No one is above the law.

Contrary to democracy, dictatorship is of a rule by one person. In a dictatorship, people are asked not to think, but to obey and follow him blindly exploiting rights and freedom of speech.

Parliamentary Form of Government

A parliamentary form is one in which the power of government is exercised by the legislature known as "Parliament". A distinguishing feature of parliamentary government is that executive power is not separated from legislative power as in other systems of government. The legislature elects the executive, that is, the Prime Minister, who selects

cabinet members from members in the legislature. The executive is accountable to the legislative assembly.



Branches of Government

- **Legislative Branch**

Pakistan's legislative branch is a bicameral Parliament, officially termed as Majlis-e-Shoora. The Parliament consists of two houses i-e the National Assembly (also known as the lower house) and the Senate (also known as the upper house).

- **Executive Branch**

The executive branch is made up of the Prime Minister and the President. The Prime Minister is the head of government in Pakistan. The President, on the other hand, is a ceremonial head of state with fewer responsibilities.

- **Judicial Branch**

Pakistan's judicial system includes a Supreme Court, Federal Shariat Court, Provincial High Courts, and other courts and tribunals.

SUMMARY

A group of people that governs the country with a system is called the government. The government makes the laws and policies to run the country. The government protects the people, provides basic services like water, electricity, security etc. Pakistan is a democratic state and it has a parliamentary form of government. The Government of Pakistan has three branches i-e the Legislative, the Executive and the Judicial branches.

END OF CHAPTER EXERCISE

A. Check Your Knowledge and Understanding

1. Fill in the Blanks

- i. The system by which a community is governed called _____.
- ii. The government makes _____ to rule the country.
- iii. Pakistan has a _____, _____ and _____ form of government.
- iv. In a federal system of government, powers are shared between the _____ and the _____.
- v. In a parliamentary form of government, the legislative and executive branches are not _____.

2. Make a Table to show three countries that have a federal system of government, three countries have a parliamentary form of government and three that have a democratic form of government.

3. Write Short Answers of the Following Questions

- i. Define the term 'government'.
- ii. List the purposes of a government.
- iii. What is meant by a federal system of government?
- iv. Name the federating units of Pakistan.
- v. What is the main feature of a parliamentary form of government?
- vi. How do the people choose their representatives in a democratic form of government?

B. Conduct an Inquiry

1. Conduct an inquiry to find out three countries that have a form of government similar to the form of Pakistan: federal, parliamentary and democratic.

C. Cooperate With Others

1. Work together in groups of four, use a scale to assess how well the current government of Pakistan is fulfilling its purpose. Suggest three things they could do to better fulfill the purposes of government.

CHAPTER 2: ORGANIZATION AND FUNCTIONS OF THE FEDERAL GOVERNMENT

SLOs

- Identify the organizational structure of the federal government of Pakistan (legislative, executive and judicial branches).
- Describe the power and functions of each branch of government.
- Describe how the Prime Minister, members of the national assembly and justices of the Supreme Court come to power (election v.s appointments).
- Explain why powers of government are separated among the three branches.
- Give examples of how the system of checks and balances limits the power of the federal government (e.g. senate not agreeing to legislation, courts declaring a law unconstitutional).
- Differentiate between those branches and institutions of government that are permanent and temporary.
- Identify the role of the civil and military bureaucracies.
- Distinguish between federal and provincial government.
- Make a chart to show the relationship between courts in the judicial system of Pakistan.
- Identify unjust situation and say how they can be made more just?
- Discuss in groups the importance of ensuring justice to reach member of the society.

Introduction

This chapter deals with the study of Federal Government of Pakistan and the functions of the various branches of the government.

The Federal Government

The Constitution of the Islamic Republic of Pakistan 1973 provides for a federal, parliamentary and democratic form of government. A federal system of government means that there are two levels of governments, that is, federal and provincial, with decision making powers divided between them. The federal government is responsible for matters that concern Pakistan as a whole and require a national policy such as defence, foreign affairs, and finance. The provincial governments are responsible for matters that concern each province such as law enforcement, education and health care.



National Assembly



Prime Minister's Secretariat



Supreme Court

Federal government (like the provincial government that we learnt about in class four) has three branches: the Legislative Branch, the Executive Branch, and the Judicial Branch.

Activity:

- Draw a pyramid with three levels. List the matters that each level of government: federal, provincial and local is responsible for.

The Legislative Branch (Parliament)

The Legislative branch of the Federal Government consists of two houses of Parliament, the lower house called the National Assembly and the upper house known as the Senate.

The National Assembly of Pakistan

The total membership of the **National Assembly** is 342. The 272 members are elected for a five year term. The other 70 members (60 women and 10 religious minorities) are selected by the political parties in proportion to the seats won by them in the elections.

Elections to the National Assembly

Political parties take part in the elections. Candidates for election in different constituencies are selected by political parties. On the day of the elections, all voters vote for the candidate of their choice in their constituency. After elections, the votes

Do You Know?

To become a member of the Senate one must:

- Be a citizen of Pakistan.
- Be not less than 30 years of age.
- Be enrolled as a voter in the electoral list.
- Be a good moral character.

are counted. The candidate with the majority votes is elected and becomes a member of the National Assembly (MNA).

The Senate

The Senate has 104 members. It is a permanent legislative body which ensures continuity in national affairs. The term of its members is six years. However, one-half of its members retire after every three years.

Provinces / Territories	General	Technocrats / Ulema	Women	Non-Muslims	Total
Sindh	14	4	4	1	23
Punjab	14	4	4	1	23
Balochistan	14	4	4	1	23
Khyber Pakhtunkhwa	14	4	4	1	23
Federal Capital	2	1	1	-	4
FATA	8	-	-	-	8
GRAND TOTAL	66	17	17	4	104

Representation of the Provinces in the Senate



People standing in line at a polling booth.



People stamping on their symbols.



People casting their vote inside booth.

Voter

A voter is a Pakistani citizen who is 18 years old and above and whose name appears on the voters list.

Senate Elections

Each of the four provincial assemblies elects twenty three members of the Senate; fourteen on general seats, four on the seats reserved for technocrats/Ulema, four on seats reserved for women and one on a seat reserved for non-Muslims.

Functions of Parliament

Legislation: The main function of parliament is to make new laws and change existing laws. Both the National Assembly and the Senate can propose and pass laws, except for finance bills which only the National

Assembly can approve. Laws proposed are discussed and debated before approval.

Representation: Members of the National Assembly serve as a link between the government and the people. They are representatives of the people and their main responsibility is to act on behalf of the people.

Scrutiny and Oversight: Assemblies check executive power so that government is made responsible and/or accountable. To fulfill these functions, ministers are regularly asked questions in oral or written form usually by members of the opposition in the assemblies.

Recruitment and Training: Assemblies serve to recruit and train future leaders. In a parliamentary form like we have in Pakistan, ministers continue to hold their assembly seats alongside their executive offices thus, giving them some training in leadership.

Legitimacy: Assemblies also promote the legitimacy of a government by encouraging the public to see the system of rule as 'rightful'.

How Parliament Carries out its Functions?

In order to carry out its functions, the National Assembly must meet at least three times in a year and for at least 130 days. At its first session, the National Assembly elects from amongst its members a Speaker and a Deputy Speaker. The Speaker presides over the National Assembly. The speaker's role is to moderate debate, make rulings on procedure and announce the results of votes. The speaker is supposed to be non-partisan and impartial (does not take sides) in the discharge of functions. In the absence of the Speaker, the Deputy Speaker acts as the Speaker.

Most of the work undertaken by the National Assembly is done by Standing Committees. The Standing Committees examine bills referred to them by the House and submit its reports to the House. Bills passed by the house are then sent to the Senate.

In order to carry out its functions, the Senate must meet for 110 days in at least three sessions in the year. At its first meeting, the Senate elects from amongst its members a Chairman and Deputy Chairman for a term of three Years.

Like the National Assembly, the Senate of Pakistan has a Standing Committee System. All the bills are sent to a Committee that examines them and then presents in the Senate, where they are discussed and a decision of whether to pass or not is made. The proceedings of the legislature are shared with the general public so as to create awareness of the citizens.

Find out from the newspapers and stick pictures of the Head of State, Head of the Federal Government and the Chief Justice of Pakistan

Chief Justice

President

Prime Minister

Activity:

- Work in groups of four, make a rule for your class. Each group should present its rule; the rule should be discussed and then voted on. If a majority votes for the rule, the rule is passed and should be followed.

The Executive Branch

The executive branch carries out and enforces the laws. It consists of the following:

- **The President** who is the head of State.
- **The Prime Minister** who is the head of the Federal Government.
- **The Cabinet** which comprises the Prime Minister and Ministers. The Ministers are members of the National Assembly chosen by the Prime Minister to head different ministries.
- **The officers of the Civil and Military (Bureaucracy).**

Functions of the Executive

Ceremonial Duties: The head of State (President), the head of the Government (Prime Minister) as well as senior ministers and secretaries play largely ceremonial roles on occasions, foreign visits, and the signing of treaties and legislation.

Implementations of Policies: The executive is expected to 'govern' by

developing coherent economic and social policies including education policies for the country and maintain its relations with foreign countries. The executive is also responsible for implementation of policies.

Run the Government: The executive is responsible for running the government. The ministers are responsible for ministries and their work is supported by the civil servants.

Crisis Management: It is the duty of Government to enforce rule of law to maintain public order and handle economic and political crisis.

Disaster Management: A key function of the executive is to take quick and decisive action in the management of major disaster including earthquake, land-slides, floods and feminine etc.

The Civil Bureaucracy

The members of the civil bureaucracy are not elected; they are employees of the government. The civil bureaucracy is organized in ministries each charged with responsibility for particular policy areas, such as the ministry of finance and the ministry of foreign affairs. Staff members are involved in gathering statistics, researching and writing details for new laws, collecting taxes and performing thousands of other tasks necessary for a government to run effectively.

Functions of the Civil Bureaucracy

Administration: The core function of the civil bureaucracy is to implement government policy.

Offer Policy Advice: Civil bureaucrats may advise politicians. They often control the flow of information to politicians, determining what and how much politicians know.

Articulate Interests: The civil bureaucracy has to work with interest groups as they formulate and implement policy.

Maintain Political Stability: A function of civil bureaucracy is to provide political stability and continuity of the systems. Unlike ministers and governments that come and go; professional civil servants hold their positions permanently.

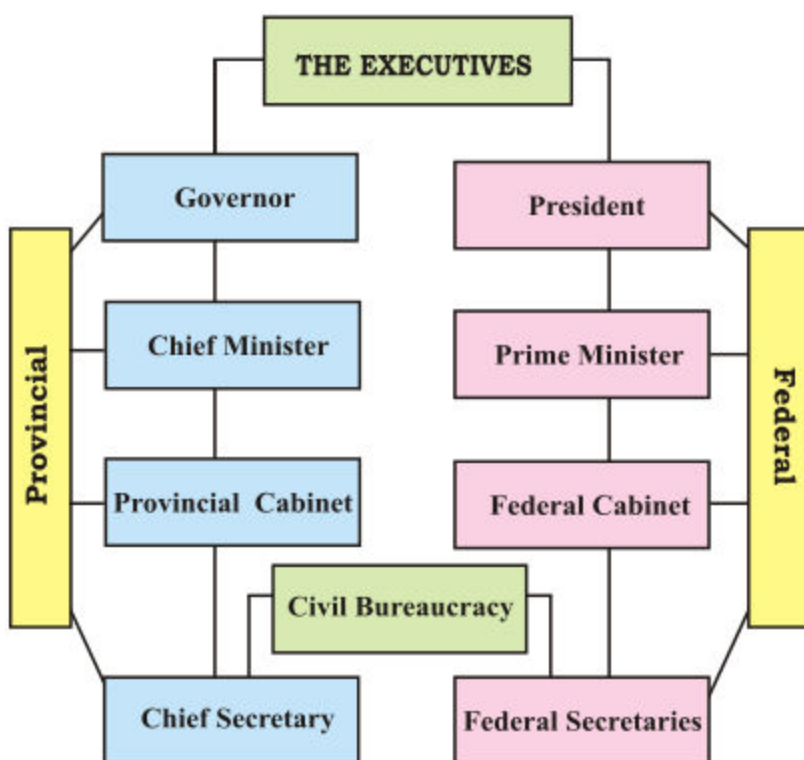
The Military Bureaucracy

Like the civil bureaucracy, there is the military bureaucracy. The military also called the armed forces (army, navy and air force) are the only ones who are allowed to use deadly force and weapons to protect the

interest of the state and the citizens. The main job of the armed forces is to “defend Pakistan against external aggression or threat of war and as per law act in the civil power when called to so”. The armed forces are usually called to help civil power in times of natural or man-made disasters.

To support the work of the military, many other tasks have to be performed by many other people. There is a need for logistics (trucks and drivers, cooks and food), maintenance, communications, command and intelligence. The soldiers including the people who support them all have to follow rules and orders as per the chain of command.

In a democracy, political control of the armed forces is with the civilian institutions. Therefore, in Pakistan the Federal Government has control and command over the armed forces and the President is the Supreme Commander of the Armed Forces.



Do you know

What is constitution?

The constitution is a system of laws and rules by which a country is governed.

The constitution describes the relations between federal government and provincial governments. It also describes the rights and responsibilities of citizens. Constitution tells us the powers of three branches of government.

The Judicial Branch

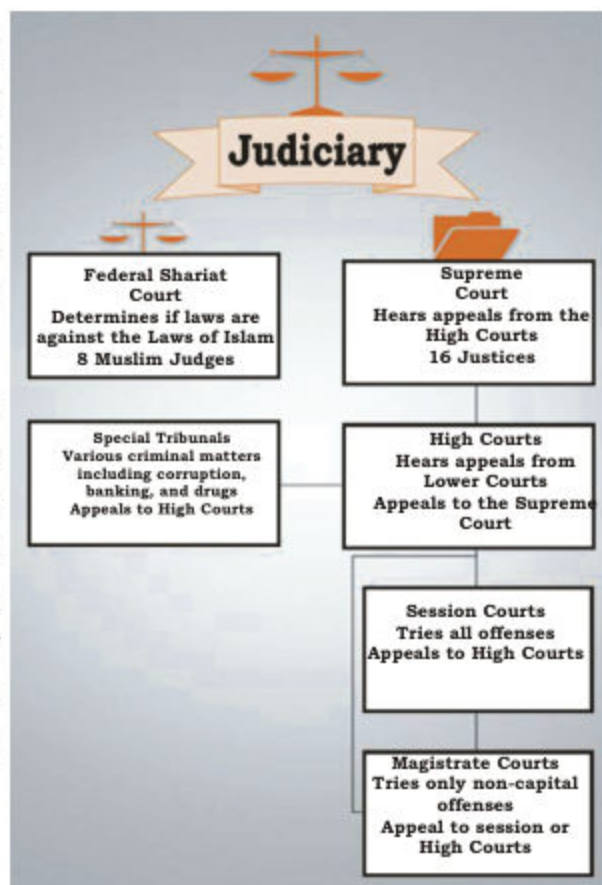
The judicial branch of the Federal Government comprises of the Supreme Court, High Courts, the Federal Shariat Court, the subordinate courts and special courts and tribunals. The Supreme Court is the highest court of Pakistan

The Chief Justice of the Supreme Court is appointed by the President with the aid and advice of the Prime Minister. The other Supreme Court judges are appointed by the President after consultation with the Chief Justice. The Chief Justice and judges of the Supreme Court may remain in office until the age of 65.

Functions of the Supreme Court

The main functions of the supreme court are as under:

- i. The disputes between the Provincial and Federal Government are decided by the Supreme Court.
- ii. Inter-Provincial disputes are settled by the Supreme Court.
- iii. To hear the cases of appeals of the lower courts.
- iv. To take suo motto action on the most important issues.
- v. To protect and guard the Constitution of Islamic Republic of Pakistan 1973.
- vi. To review the laws passed by Parliament.
- vii. The Federal Government can take advice on the constitutional and judicial matters.
- viii. The judgment of the Supreme Court of Pakistan is final and binding upon the Federal and Provincial Governments.
- ix. To protect the fundamental rights guaranteed in the 1973 constitution of Pakistan.



Activity:

- Why justice is important for society? Write down a few sentences about this?

The Provincial Government

Like the Federal government, the provincial governments are also organized into three branches: the Legislative, the Executive and Judicial branch. Although, the functions of each are the same they are organized differently. Unlike the legislative branch of the Federal Government which has two houses, the legislative branch of the provincial government has only one house, the Provincial Assembly. The executive in the provincial government comprises the Governor (Head of Province), Chief Minister (Head of Provincial Government), Provincial cabinet and civil bureaucracy. The judicial branch consists of the High Court, which is the highest Court of the Province and the lower courts.

SUMMARY

According to the Constitution, there are three branches of government in Pakistan. Legislative Branch, Executive Branch, and the Judicial Branch. The Legislative branch makes the laws, the Executive carries out laws and Judiciary evaluates and interprets the laws. The legislative branch or Parliament has two houses: the National Assembly and the Senate. The National Assembly of Pakistan is the country's sovereign legislative body. It makes laws for the Federation and keeps a check over the Executive. The Senate is a body which represents the provinces and promotes a feeling of equality, peace and harmony, which is essential for the growth and prosperity of a nation. The executive branch implements the law and public policies. It includes the President, Prime minister, the Cabinet and, executive officers of the civil and military bureaucracy. The judicial branch administers justice, makes laws, acts as guardian of the constitution and protects the rights and freedom of citizens. The Supreme Court is the highest court of Pakistan.

END OF CHAPTER EXERCISE

A. Check Your Knowledge and Understanding

1. Fill in the Blanks

- i. Three branches of government are _____, _____ and _____.
- ii. The legislative branch or parliament consists of two houses: _____ and _____.
- iii. The Head of Government is the _____.
- iv. The Prime Minister appoints the cabinet from the members of the _____.
- v. The highest court of Pakistan is the _____.

2. Make a Table to show the functions of each branch of government.

3. Answer the Following Questions

- i. Name the branches of government and state the main task of each.
- ii. List the functions of the legislative branch.
- iii. Describe the purpose of the senate.
- iv. How are members of the National Assembly elected?
- v. Who makes up the executive in the federal government?
- vi. Describe the importance of the Judiciary.
- vii. Write similarities and differences between the Federal and Provincial governments.
- viii. Review the fundamental rights in the constitution of Pakistan and list the five that you think are most important for you.

B. Cooperate With Others

1. In small groups of four, make a diagram to show the difference between the following:
 - The legislative branch of the federal and provincial government.
 - The members of the executive branch of the federal and the provincial government.
 - The court system in the federal and provincial governments.

CHAPTER 3: LOCAL GOVERNMENT

SLOs

- Identify key features of local government.
- Name some local government institutions.
- Identify services commonly provided by local government (e.g. police, fire department, schools, Libraries, parks, health and cleanliness) and describe how they are funded (e.g. taxes, fees, fines).
- Give examples to show how local government affects the lives of its citizens.

Introduction

This chapter deals with the study of Local Government, its structure and organization. This chapter explains functions of the three levels of local government. It also describes the role of citizen under local government.

What is Local Government?

Local Government is the lowest level of Government. It is the government that runs the administration of a particular district, town, or union. The government is made up of representatives elected by the people. Local government gives people the power and authority to make decisions about matters that affect them.

The aims and objectives of the local government system are to:

1. Extend responsibility of the State to the citizens in their local communities.
2. Shift power and authority of government to the local level so that people's needs are served.
3. Provide opportunities for people to participate in decisions affecting their lives.
4. Allow communities to determine their needs and allocate resources to meet their needs.
5. Establish a basic foundation for the practice of democracy.

Structure and Organization of the Local Government System

According to Sindh Local Govt Act 2013, the Local Govt Act 2013 provides for three tier (system) local government. These three tiers (levels) include district council, taluka council and union council.

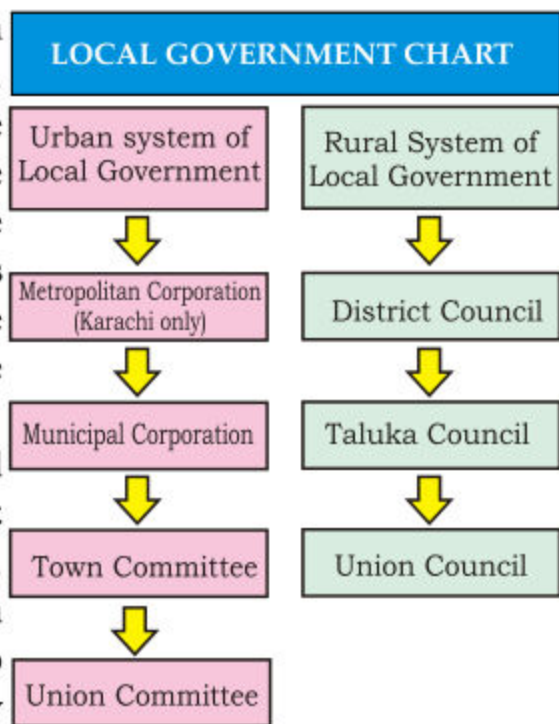
Terms of Local Government According to Local Government Act 2013

Term	Definition	Functions
Union Council	It is the basic tier of local government administration. It is consisted of villages.	• Registration of births, deaths and marriages. • Provides street lights and repair street roads and maintain drainage lines, hand pumps.
Taluka Council	Another tier of Local Government administration at taluka level is called Taluka Council.	• Exercising control over land development, agriculture, industry, commerce, residence, recreation, entertainment, transport, etc. • Regulating markets, issuing licenses, granting permissions as well as imposing penalties against violations. • Developing and managing schemes, including site development, in collaboration with district government. Formulating strategies for infrastructure development, improvement in delivery of services and implementation of laws. • Monitoring and supervising the performance of government offices located in the tehsil and hold them accountable by reporting to the district government.
District Council	A tier of Local Government working at District Level is called District Council.	• Approves development plans. • Approves annual budget. • Monitor and improve delivery of services.
Town Committee	Town Committee governs a small urban town. It is composed of wards or union committees.	• Building dispensaries, maternity homes and inns for the welfare of the town's people. • Constructing and repair roads, lanes, footpaths and walkways. Laying gardens and plant trees. • Providing playgrounds. Setting up public libraries. Carrying out all such works which promote public welfare.
Municipal Corporation	A division of geographic urban areas which performs certain functions on a local level.	• Setting up and maintaining playgrounds, libraries and zoos and to arrange recreational sports, fares etc. • Constructing and maintaining roads in the respective areas and plant trees along the roadside. • Arranging water supply for public places and private homes. Providing for fire brigade service to extinguish fire, if it breaks out.
Metropolitan Corporation	A type of local administration of major cities including Karachi.	• Monitoring and supervision of all works in the city, maintenance of Parks, Sports Complex etc. • Planning, development and maintenance of Inter-district roads, bridges, street lights and storm water drains. Control of Land owned by Metropolitan Corporation. • Removal of Encroachments from the properties owned by Metropolitan Corporation. Maintenance of Abattoirs and Cattle Colonies, Art Gallery, Museum and Library. Reception of Foreign dignitaries.

Source: Local Govt Act 2013.

Each level has an elected Chairman and Vice Chairman, elected councilors, and administrators. All members of the local government are accountable to the Chairman, who is an *elected* official. The Chairman has powers and responsibilities for development and cleanliness of the cities. In metropolitan cities, they are called Mayors and Deputy Mayors.

There are **direct elections** for general seats in union councils, and **indirect elections** for reserved seats of women, peasants/ workers and minorities in union councils. Indirect elections are also held for tehsils/towns and districts/city district councils. Councilors are elected on the non-Party basis and serve a four-year term.



Functions of the Three Levels of Local Government

The functions of the councils at the three levels are to approve the annual development plan and budget, collect taxes and facilitate formation of various citizen committees. The main functions of the administration are to improve public services including maintenance of roads, public parks, schools, hospitals and provision of water supply and sanitation.



Shahi Bagh/Park, Shikarpur



HM Khoja High School, Nawab Shah



Abbasi Shaheed Hospital, Karachi

Citizen's Role Under Local Government

There are many opportunities for citizen's active participation through the above institutional arrangements.

- If you are 25 years and above, you can stand for elections to any of the above and if elected play an active and responsible role.
- You can become a member of one of the many committees that work to improve the community.
- You can also join together with others to form a Community Based Organization (CBO) to address the needs of your community.
- You can make complaints in the complaint cell or bring complaints against various members of the local government to ensure greater accountability and improved services for your community.

SUMMARY

Local Government is the lowest level of government. The power and authority are transferred at local level to resolve local level problems faced by people. The aim of the Local Government is to provide basic facilities to the people at local level.

END OF CHAPTER EXERCISE

A. Check Your Knowledge and Understanding

1. Answer the Following Questions

- i. What is Local Government?
- ii. Explain the structure of Local Government.
- iii. Differentiate between the powers of Tehsil Council and Union Council.

2. Make a Table to show the hierarchical structure of Local Government.

B. Cooperate With Others

1. Make a small group and discuss the role of Local Government.

C. Conduct an Inquiry

1. Find out three Local level issues which have not yet been resolved by the Local Government.

CHAPTER 4: ELECTIONS

SLOs

- Define the term election, electorate and representative.
- State the importance of elections in a democracy.
- State the importance of active citizen's participation in the electoral process in a democracy.
- Describe ways people can participate in public life including voting, petitioning elected officials, and volunteering.
- Give examples of opportunities for citizens to participate in the electoral process (voting, observer in elections, and stand for elections).
- Identify the problem women citizens have in participating in the political process and suggest ways to address them.
- Go through the electoral process in school (e.g. elections for class monitor, election of members and leaders of the school council).
- Examine the role of media in the election process.
- Role of political parties in the electoral process in Pakistan.

Introduction

This chapter deals with the study of importance of the electoral system for democracy. It also explains the functions of the Election Commission of Pakistan.

What is an Election?

Pakistan is a democratic state. According to Abraham Lincoln democracy means “government of the people, by the people for the people”. Modern states have vast territories and large populations. It is physically impossible for all the people in such states to assemble in one place to take part in making laws and policies about matters that affect them all. They can take part in the business of the state only indirectly, that is, through their representatives whom they elect to make laws and policies and to decide other affairs of the state.

All the citizens of a state, who at a particular time have the right to vote, are collectively called the **electorate**. The process in which the electorate exercises its right to vote to select its representatives is called an **election** and the people whom they elect to the legislature are called **representatives**.

Activity:

- What qualities you like the most and wish to have in the representative in your area.

Importance of Election in a Democracy

Elections make an important contribution to democratic governance by providing the following:

Choice of Leadership: Elections provide a way for the citizens to choose their representatives. They do so by casting their vote in favour of the candidate whom they think will act in their best interest. This ensures that the will of the people is reflected in the elected candidates.

Change of Leadership: Elections are a platform for the public to show their displeasure with the ruling party. By voting for candidates from another political party and helping elect a different government, citizens demonstrate that they are the ultimate authority in a democracy.

Political Participation: If a citizen wishes to introduce reforms that are not on the agenda of any of the parties, he or she is free to contest the elections either independently or by forming a new political party.

Self-corrective System: Because elections are a regular exercise (occurring every five years in Pakistan), the ruling party has to consider the demands of the public. This works as a self-corrective system whereby the ruling party reviews its performance and tries to improve it so as to keep the voters happy.

Political Education: Elections provide political education for citizens and ensure the responsiveness of democratic governments to the will of the people.

Activity:

- Explain five ways in which elections are useful for national development.

Who Can Cast the Vote?

A person, who is a citizen of Pakistan, of not less than 18 years of age, of sound mind and is a resident of an electoral area, can get himself/herself enrolled as a voter in the place where he/she lives. Only citizens registered on the Electoral Rolls are eligible to cast their votes.

Who Can Contest Elections in Pakistan?

Everyone who is a citizen of Pakistan, enrolled as a voter in any electoral roll, is 25 years of age or above (30 years in the Senate), is of good character and has not been convicted of a crime can stand in the elections and become a member of the National Assembly or a Provincial Assembly if he/she obtains the necessary votes.

Activity:

- Make an inquiry to find out the problems women face in casting their votes and contesting the elections. Suggest five things that can be done to deal with these problems.

The Election Commission of Pakistan (ECP)

The Election Commission of Pakistan is an independent body whose task is to organize and conduct free, fair and transparent elections to the National Assembly, Senate, Provincial Assemblies, and Local Government Institutions. The Election Commission consists of the Chief Election Commissioner (CEC) as Chairman and four Members appointed on the recommendation of a Parliamentary Committee comprising equal members from the Government and the Opposition. The CEC has to be a serving or a former judge of the Supreme Court or of a High Court eligible for appointment as Chief Election Commissioner. The Members of the Election Commission have to be former judges of the High Courts, one from each province.

In order to organize and conduct elections honestly, justly and fairly, the Election Commission is supported by its Secretariat and the countrywide network of offices led by the Secretary ECP.

Function of the Election Commission of Pakistan (ECP)

The functions of the ECP are to organize and conduct elections honestly, justly, fairly and transparently in accordance with law; preparing and maintaining credible electoral rolls; delimiting constituencies in a transparent manner; encouraging informed voter's participation; managing electoral processes diligently; employing modern electoral technologies; ensuring inclusiveness; consolidating constructive relationships with all stakeholders; and continuing electoral reforms in Pakistan

Activity:

- Identify the role of the Provincial Election Commissioner.

Political Parties

Political parties are associations of like-minded individuals who come together to promote public policy based on a set of ideas and values. Political parties propose actions (policies) regarding public issues, problems and concerns. Political parties are organizations that seek to gain and exercise political power through elections.

Role of Political Parties

Political parties play an important role in a democracy; some of their roles are mentioned below:

- **Aggregate Public Opinion** by expressing their views on public issues help to bring different individuals and groups who share that view together.
- **Recruit Political Leaders** by offering people opportunities to hold public office.
- **Nominate Candidates** for election to public office.
- **Conduct Election Campaigns** that show the programs they have to address public issues, problems and concerns.
- **Control the Executive Branch of Government** through elected officials.
- **Provide Members With a Feeling of Belonging** to those who are like-minded.

Political parties play a very important role in the conduct of elections, in Pakistan some of the roles they play are as follows:

- Help the electorate to get their Computerized National Identity Cards.
- Help electorate to get enrolled in the electoral rolls.
- Provide party tickets to candidates of their choice.
- Educate the electorate about the party's position on public issues, problems and concerns as given in the manifesto and its commitment to address them should they win.
- Motivate the electorate to cast their vote in favour of their party candidate.
- Get voters out to vote on Election Day; providing transport to the voters if needed.
- Depute polling agents at polling stations on Election Day to facilitate voters in casting their votes.

Role of Media in Elections

The press, radio, television, and the internet all play an important role in democracy. They have two main roles: to keep the public informed about public issues, problems and concerns so that the public can judge the government's performance and to watch those in power and report their actions to the public so that the public can choose public officials and political parties at the time of elections.

If the media is to 'watch' the conduct of public affairs proceedings such as those of law making in the legislature, court proceeding and other hearings such be 'open' to the public. Along with transparency (open to the public), the media must be independent, that is, free of government control, threat or manipulation), and plural, that it a variety of views should be presented.

During elections, the media plays the following roles:

- Provide reporting and visual coverage of the candidates from all political parties in an objective and impartial manner.
- Provide information about the candidate's own and their political party's position on various public issues, problems and concerns.
- Ask tough questions about public issues in interviews with candidates.
- Hold and cover debates between candidates of various political parties.
- Report results of elections in a timely manner.

Active Citizenship

Active citizenship means people getting involved in their local communities and democracy at all levels, from towns to cities to the country. Active citizenship can be as small as a campaign to clean up your street or as big as educating young people about democratic values, skills and participation. Active citizenship is one of the most important steps towards a healthy democracy especially in Pakistan.

Ways Citizens Can Participate in Public Life

There are many ways in which citizens can participate in improving their society and creating a healthy democracy:

- Becoming informed about the village, town or city one lives in by reading the newspapers, listening to the radio, watching television or finding out information on the internet.
- Writing letters to your MPA, MNA or the newspaper.
- Becoming a member of or starting a Community Based Organization (CBO) to work to improve the community.

- Keeping your community clean and green.
- Obeying the law.
- Signing a petition aimed at getting responsible people to take action.
- Demonstrating peacefully through marches, boycotts, sit-ins or other forms of protest.
- Serving the country through military or other service.

An important role of citizens in public life is playing an active role during elections. There are many ways in which citizens can participate in elections some of which are given below:

- Vote in local, provincial, and national elections.
- Become a member of a political party.
- Stand for public office.
- Support the campaign of a candidate by making a financial contribution to the party or volunteering time in the campaign office.
- Bring out voters to vote on Election Day.
- Act as an observer of elections on Election Day.

SUMMARY

Elections are essential to democracy as it is through elections that the people choose candidates to represent them and to hold public office. Elections are important because they help us choose our leaders, change our leaders, provide us an opportunity to participate in the political process and educate us. The Election Commission of Pakistan plays an important role in the organization and conduct of free, fair and transparent elections. Political parties are associations of like-minded individuals who propose actions (policies) regarding public issues, problems and concerns. They seek to gain and exercise political power through elections. Their role in elections is to help the electorate to get their CNICs and get enrolled in the electoral rolls, provide party tickets to candidates of their choice, educate and motivate the electorate to vote for their party candidate and facilitate them on Election Day. The media has a key role to play in elections by keeping the public informed about candidates and political party's positions on public issues and by reporting the results of elections in a timely manner. Citizens have a very important role to play in helping to create and sustain a democratic society. They can participate actively by keeping themselves informed about public issues and working with others to address them. During elections, their most important role is to vote for their representatives.

END OF CHAPTER EXERCISE

A. Check Your Knowledge and Understanding

1. Fill in the Blanks

- i. In Pakistan, general elections are held after every _____ years.
- ii. The age of the voter in Pakistan is _____ years.
- iii. The minimum age of the representatives in Pakistan is _____ years.
- iv. The body which is responsible for conducting the elections in the country is called _____.

2. Make a Table to show the role of the Election Commission, Political parties, the media and citizens in elections.

3. Answer the Following Questions

- i. Define the term 'election', 'electorate' and 'representative'.
- ii. List the way citizens can participate in improving their society.

B. Conduct an Inquiry

1. Make an inquiry to find out who is the MPA and MNA from the area in which you live. Find out which political party they belong to. Find out what is the position of their political party on education. If the political party is in power, do you think it is doing what it promised to promote education in Pakistan or in Sindh?

C. Cooperate With Others

1. Conduct elections for the monitor of your class. Nominate three students. Have these students developed a manifesto stating what they will do for the students in the class. Have them present their manifesto and campaign to convince students to vote for them. Hold the elections, count the votes and declare the winner.

END OF UNIT EXERCISE

A. Check Your Knowledge and Understanding

1. Match the Public Office Given in Column A With Role (s) Official in Column B

Column A	Column B
Chairman of the Senate	Plays ceremonial role in state occasions and foreign visits and sign treaties and legislation.
President of Pakistan	
	Is a leader of the house (NA).
Prime Minister of Pakistan	Acts as the President when the President is out of the country.

B. Use Your Inquiry /Investigation Skills

1. Find out the members of National and Provincial Assemblies elected from your district during the general elections of 2013.
2. Find out the names of provincial and federal ministers belonging to your district.

C. Communicate With Others

1. Make a group and discuss the powers of the Supreme Court including the power of reviewing laws passed by Parliament.

D. Cooperate With Others

1. Arrange a focus group discussion and engage the students in debate about foreign policy issue i-e deteriorating relations between India and Pakistan due to the acts of violence in Kashmir by India.

E. Be Creative

1. Develop an online procedure for complaining about the ineffective delivery of service provided by Local Government.

F. Become Technologically Smart

1. Share your idea of online procedure on Facebook and get positive feedback from your friends.

G. Take an Action for the Common Good

1. Write a letter to the editor of the newspaper and highlight the shortage of drinking water in your area.